

# THE ORPHANED WEST

A mythic micro-drama production bible

Series myth - 88 episode guide - AI production stack - automation plan

The West killed its father, fled its home, worshiped machines, survived dragons, entered the mirror, and now must decide whether it wants to become human again.

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# Executive Summary

This PDF consolidates the full concept developed so far for The Orphaned West: the mythic frame, recurring archetypes, 88-episode micro-drama guide, production approach, current AI tool stack, and a single-interface automation plan. The goal is to make the project executable with Laurent as showrunner and reviewer, not as manual prompt operator.

**Recommended format:** vertical animated mythic drama, not photoreal live action.

The production strategy is to use a stylized, graphic-novel / stained-glass / animated historical fresco look. This gives the series a mythic tone, reduces AI continuity drift, and avoids the uncanny feeling of fake documentary footage.

The production strategy is also deliberately automation-first: one repo, one command surface, a few APIs underneath, strict review gates, and reusable bibles for character, style, prompts, and episode structure.

|                  |                                                                             |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Series           | The Orphaned West                                                           |
| Format           | 60-90 second vertical micro-drama episodes                                  |
| Structure        | Trailer + 88 episodes across 7 seasons                                      |
| Clip grammar     | 6-9 clips per episode; each clip 6-10 seconds                               |
| Visual approach  | Stylized animated myth-drama; graphic novel realism; stained-glass lighting |
| Human role       | Approve bibles, scripts, references, clip takes, and final exports          |
| Automation stack | Codex or Claude Code + OpenAI API + Runway API + ElevenLabs API + FFmpeg    |

# Part I - The Myth Bible

The following section preserves the mythic narrative created for the Western tradition since 1914. It is intended as the philosophical and symbolic source code of the series.

## The mythic tale of the West since 1914

The Western Tradition's 20th-century myth would not begin with birth. It would begin with **a murder**.

Not simply the murder of Archduke Franz Ferdinand, but the murder of an older world.

The myth might be called:

## The Orphaned West

Or:

## The Long Eclipse and the Return of the Human Face

The main character is **the West itself**: half Greek seeker, half Roman builder, half Christian pilgrim. A civilization raised on Athens, Rome, Jerusalem, and the North. It believed in reason, law, sacrifice, beauty, God, heroism, and progress. But by 1914, it had become proud. It thought it had outgrown the gods.

Then the guns began.

## Act I: The Golden City and the Wound

Before 1914, the West lives in a glittering city of iron, steam, cathedrals, parliaments, universities, empires, factories, and salons.

It thinks it has mastered history.

It believes science will tame nature, trade will tame war, education will tame savagery, and progress will tame the human soul.

But beneath the marble floor, something ancient is moving.

The old myths had warned about this.

The Greeks called it **hubris**.

The Norse would have called it the shadow before **Ragnarök**.

Christianity would call it **pride before the fall**.

Then comes 1914.

The young men descend into the trenches like souls entering the underworld. Europe becomes a sacrificial altar. The flower of nations is fed to the machine. The heroic ideal is not killed by cowardice, but by artillery, gas, mud, bureaucracy, and mass death.

The West does not merely lose a war.

It loses innocence.

Its first death is the death of the belief that civilization automatically makes men good.

## Act II: The False Resurrections

After the Great War, the West is wounded, humiliated, fatherless, and spiritually concussed.

It wants resurrection.

But instead of true resurrection, it is offered counterfeit resurrections.

The 20th century becomes the age of false saviors.

One says: **the Nation will save you.**

Another says: **the Class will save you.**

Another says: **the Race will save you.**

Another says: **the Market will save you.**

Another says: **the Machine will save you.**

Another says: **the Self will save you.**

These are not just political programs. In mythic terms, they are idols. They are new gods demanding sacrifice.

The great villain here is not only Hitler, Stalin, Mao, or any one tyrant. They are avatars of something deeper.

The deeper villain is **the replacement of the person with the abstraction.**

The human being becomes a unit, a worker, a racial type, a consumer, a data point, a problem to be solved, a mouth to feed, a body to manage, a vote to harvest, a psychological profile, a biological accident.

This is the rise of the great monster:

# The Machine Without a Soul

It has many faces: bureaucracy, ideology, propaganda, mass war, industrial killing, technocracy, surveillance, and later, algorithmic manipulation.

It does not always look evil. Often it looks efficient.

That is why it is so dangerous.

## Act III: The Dragon War

World War II is the dragon battle.

The dragon wears modern clothing but has ancient hunger. It wants blood, purity, domination, ritual, spectacle, and total obedience.

Nazism is not merely political evil. Mythically, it is a pagan parody: a fake return to blood, soil, tribe, destiny, and heroic violence.

Communism is another dragon form: a secular apocalypse promising a classless heaven after enough enemies are burned away.

The West must fight monsters outside itself while discovering that some of the same impulses live inside itself.

This is what makes the myth tragic.

The heroes are real, but not pure.

The Allies defeat the Nazi dragon, but they do so with bombers, firestorms, espionage, propaganda, and finally the atomic bomb. They save civilization while discovering they too now possess godlike powers of destruction.

The hero survives the dragon, but comes home carrying dragon-fire.

That fire is Hiroshima.

That fire is the knowledge that man can now end the world.

## Act IV: The Cold War Under the Shadow of the Bomb

After 1945, the West enters a long twilight.

Two towers rise.

One tower says: **man is matter, history is destiny, the state is god.**

The other says: **man is free, but perhaps freedom mainly means choice, comfort, consumption, and self-invention.**

The Cold War becomes a mythic siege. The West defends liberty against totalitarianism, but also slowly forgets what liberty is for.

This is where the story becomes subtle.

The West wins against Soviet communism not only with missiles and markets, but with memory, faith, art, courage, and truth-telling.

The great heroes of this act are not just presidents and generals. They are dissidents, priests, workers, writers, mothers, prisoners, musicians, and people who refuse to say the lie.

The central heroic act is very simple:

**To say what is true when everyone is forced to repeat what is false.**

That is Solzhenitsyn.

That is Václav Havel.

That is Pope John Paul II.

That is the Polish worker in Solidarity.

That is the underground publisher.

That is the person who keeps a candle burning in the window.

In 1989, the wall falls.

For a brief moment, the West thinks the curse is broken.

But this is the false ending.

The hero mistakes victory over one dragon for the healing of his own soul.

## Act V: The Mirror Kingdom

After 1989, the West enters the Mirror Kingdom.

The old enemies are gone, or seem gone. There is no great external dragon. So the West turns inward.

It builds screens.

It builds networks.

It builds markets.



It builds platforms.

It builds personal brands.

It builds endless choice.

It builds a world where every person can speak, but fewer people know what to say; everyone is visible, but fewer feel known; everyone can choose an identity, but fewer know who they are.

The wizardry of this age is real. It is not fake magic.

The smartphone is a magic mirror.

The algorithm is an oracle.

AI is a talking familiar.

The cloud is a kind of invisible heaven.

The feed is a liturgy.

The influencer is a minor priest.

The brand is a household god.

The villain is no longer always a tyrant with a mustache or a party uniform. The villain is often a system of enchantment that says:

**You are free, so long as you never leave the mirror.**

The West's new crisis is not only oppression.

It is disembodiment.

It forgets the body, the family, the village, the parish, the feast, the dead, the unborn, the land, the old, the poor, and the face-to-face human being.

The Machine Without a Soul has become charming.

It has become convenient.

It has become personalized.

## The central myth

The Western Tradition since 1914 is the story of a civilization that tried to escape myth, sacrifice, sin, death, and God, only to recreate them in darker forms.

It rejected priests and got ideologues.

It rejected saints and got celebrities.

It rejected sin and got therapy without repentance.

It rejected judgment and got cancellation.

It rejected resurrection and got endless reinvention.

It rejected the soul and got identity crisis.

It rejected myth and became possessed by bad myths.

So the core narrative is:

**The West killed its father, fled its home, worshiped machines, survived dragons, conquered the world, entered the mirror, and now must decide whether it wants to become human again.**

That is the myth.

It is not primarily about whether the West becomes powerful again.

It is about whether the West can recover the sacredness of the person.

## **The heroes**

The heroes are not all of one political tribe. In a true myth, heroes are the people who preserve the human person against the machine.

### **1. The Soldier-Sufferer**

The young man in the trenches.

He is not heroic because he conquers. He is heroic because he bears witness to the cost of pride.

He is Achilles without glory.

He is the first sacrificed son.

Examples: the World War I soldier-poets, the unknown soldiers, the men buried under crosses across Europe.

### **2. The Truth-Teller**

The person who refuses the official lie.

This is one of the great Western heroic types after 1914.

Examples:

**Aleksandr Solzhenitsyn Václav Havel George Orwell Whittaker Chambers Czesław Miłosz Hannah Arendt**

Their weapon is not the sword.

Their weapon is naming things correctly.

### **3. The Martyr**

The martyr is the one who proves that the person is greater than the state.

Examples:

**Dietrich Bonhoeffer Maximilian Kolbe Edith Stein Oscar Romero the Christian and Jewish victims of totalitarian regimes the unnamed prisoners of camps and gulags**

The martyr says: you can kill the body, but you cannot make the soul bow.

## 4. The Defender of Civilization

These are the flawed guardians who hold the gate when barbarism arrives.

Examples:

**Winston Churchill** as the old lion. **Charles de Gaulle** as the wounded knight of France. **Franklin Roosevelt** as the arsenal-king. **Dwight Eisenhower** as the sober commander. **the ordinary Allied soldier** as the foot soldier of deliverance.

They are not saints. They are defenders.

In myth, defenders are often compromised because they must use force to restrain force.

## 5. The Builders of Human Dignity

These are the people who try to make the West remember its own promises.

Examples:

**Martin Luther King Jr. Dorothy Day César Chávez Lech Wałęsa Mother Teresa John Paul II**

They are heroic because they insist that the weak, poor, worker, unborn, elderly, imprisoned, segregated, or forgotten person is still fully human.

## 6. The Keeper of Memory

This is one of the most important heroic roles now.

The Keeper of Memory preserves the old stories when the culture forgets them.

Examples:

**J.R.R. Tolkien C.S. Lewis T.S. Eliot Christopher Dawson Jacques Maritain Simone Weil René Girard**

They are not merely writers. They are restorers of symbolic imagination.

They remind the West that dragons are real, sin is real, grace is real, and the smallest person may carry the fate of the world.

# The villains

The villains should not be reduced to "the Germans," "the Russians," "the Americans," "the left," "the right," or any simple group.

The real villains are spiritual forces wearing historical costumes.

## 1. Moloch: The God of Sacrifice

Moloch is the power that demands human beings be fed into systems.

He appears in:

- the trenches
- the camps
- the gulags
- the killing fields

- the abortion clinic, in a Christian moral reading
- the sweatshop
- the war machine
- the economic system that treats people as disposable
- the bureaucracy that says, "There is no alternative"

Moloch always says:

**A few must be sacrificed for the future.**

## 2. The Machine Without a Soul

This is the central villain of the modern West.

It is not technology itself.

It is technology, bureaucracy, and management detached from love, wisdom, and limits.

It asks only:

Can it be done? Can it be scaled? Can it be optimized? Can it be measured? Can it be controlled?

It never asks:

Should it be done? What is it for? What does it do to the soul? Who is harmed? What kind of person does this produce?

## 3. The Liar

The Liar is propaganda.

He says words no longer mean what they mean.

War is peace. Freedom is slavery. Killing is compassion. Control is safety. Lust is love. Despair is realism. Comfort is happiness. The person is a problem.

The Liar rules by making people afraid to say the obvious.

## 4. The Hollow King

This is the decadent ruler: wealthy, clever, credentialed, but spiritually empty.

He has no positive vision of the good.

He manages decline.

He speaks in abstractions.

He believes in nothing deeply enough to die for it, marry for it, build for it, or repent before it.

He is not always cruel. Sometimes he is pleasant.

That is part of the danger.

## 5. The False Prophet

The False Prophet sells salvation without suffering.

His message changes by era:

In the 1920s: pleasure will save you. In the 1930s: ideology will save you. In the 1950s: comfort will save you. In the 1960s: liberation from all limits will save you. In the 1980s: markets will save you. In the 2000s: connectivity will save you. In the 2020s: optimization and identity will save you.

The False Prophet is always modern.

He always says the old wisdom is obsolete.

# The wizards, prophets, and magicians

This is the most interesting category.

The wizards are those who reveal hidden powers. Some are white wizards, some are dark wizards, and some are ambiguous.

## The dark or dangerous wizards

**Nietzsche** is the prophet before the storm. He announces the death of God and sees more clearly than almost anyone what may follow. He is not simply a villain. He is more like a dangerous seer whose words are later mishandled by demons.

**Freud** opens the underworld of the self. He tells modern man: you are not transparent to yourself. Beneath reason are dreams, desires, wounds, and hidden drives.

**Marx** gives the West a rival apocalypse: fall, oppression, chosen class, revolution, final kingdom. A secularized Christian story with economics replacing sin and salvation.

**Darwin**, or more accurately Darwinism as misused by others, becomes a spell that tempts people to explain man as merely animal, competition, adaptation, and survival.

**Oppenheimer** is the Promethean wizard. He brings fire from the heavens. But the fire can consume the world.

**The advertising men, platform architects, and algorithm-makers** become the sorcerers of desire. They learn to summon attention, envy, lust, fear, tribalism, and longing at scale.

## The good wizards

**Tolkien** is the great myth-restorer. He smuggles Christian metaphysics back into the modern imagination through elves, hobbits, rings, kings, and impossible hope.

**C.S. Lewis** is the translator-wizard. He takes old Christian truth and makes it speak again to modern people.

**Chesterton** stands slightly before the main period, but he is one of the last laughing giants guarding the gate before the darkness. He teaches that ordinary things are magical because they are created.

**René Girard** is a wizard of sacrifice. He reveals the scapegoat mechanism and shows how human societies build order through victims.

**Solzhenitsyn** is the wizard who returns from the underworld. He goes into the gulag and comes back carrying a scroll.

**John Paul II** is the priest-king figure. Philosopher, actor, mystic, athlete, pastor, and geopolitical force. He stands before the machine and says: man is not merely matter.

# The tricksters

Every myth needs tricksters.

The modern West is full of them.

## The Journalist-Trickster

Sometimes a truth-teller, sometimes a court jester, sometimes a propagandist.

He can expose corruption or manufacture hysteria.

## The Artist-Trickster

Sometimes he renews imagination.

Sometimes he glamorizes decay.

He breaks idols, but often cannot build altars.

## The Entrepreneur-Trickster

Sometimes he creates tools of freedom.

Sometimes he creates new cages and calls them platforms.

He says he is democratizing the world. Sometimes he is. Sometimes he is building a casino for the soul.

## The Revolutionary-Trickster

He begins by denouncing real injustice.

But then he discovers the pleasure of destruction.

He knows what he hates before he knows what he loves.

# The symbolic places

Every myth needs geography.

The West since 1914 has its sacred and cursed places.

**The Trenches:** the underworld where old Europe dies. **Auschwitz:** the anti-cathedral of the modern age. **The Gulag:** the frozen labyrinth of ideological man. **Hiroshima:** the forbidden fire. **Berlin Wall:** the visible scar across civilization. **The Moon:** the last great heroic ascent of technological man. **The Shopping Mall:** the temple of consumer peace. **The Suburb:** the promised land of comfort and loneliness. **The University:** once monastery, later factory, now battlefield. **The Internet:** the mirror realm. **The Smartphone:** the portable oracle. **The Home:** the final battlefield. **The Parish / local community / dinner table:** possible sites of resurrection.

# The Christian shape underneath the story

The 20th century looks anti-Christian on the surface, but its drama is deeply Christian.

It is obsessed with:

- innocence and guilt
- victims and oppressors
- sacrifice and scapegoats
- apocalypse and utopia
- confession and cancellation
- purity and contamination
- redemption and identity
- death and rebirth

Modernity does not stop being religious.

It becomes religious in disguised forms.

The West's great mistake was thinking that if it rejected Christianity, it would become rational.

Instead, it often became **irrationally religious about politics, sex, race, class, nation, markets, therapy, technology, and identity.**

The sacred never disappears.

It migrates.

## The mythic ending we are currently inside

We are not at the ending.

We are in the late act where the hero has survived many external enemies but is tempted to surrender inwardly.

The West now faces one great question:

### Can it recover the human person?

Not "can it dominate the world?"

Not "can it invent more technology?"

Not "can it win the argument?"

But:

Can it remember that a human being is not a machine, not a consumer, not an identity bundle, not a data profile, not a productivity unit, not a sexual appetite, not a political category, and not a mistake?

The possible resurrection is not a return to 1913.

That world is gone.

The resurrection would have to be something deeper:

- reason reunited with wonder
- technology governed by wisdom
- freedom ordered toward the good

- masculinity and femininity healed rather than weaponized
- family restored as a living cell of civilization
- art restored as beauty, not only transgression
- religion restored as encounter, not mere tribal marker
- politics lowered from false religion back into practical stewardship
- the person placed above the system

## The one-paragraph myth

Since 1914, the West has been the story of a proud civilization that descended into the trenches, died, tried to resurrect itself through ideology, defeated dragons, stole atomic fire, built a kingdom of mirrors, and then discovered that its greatest danger was not poverty, invasion, or ignorance, but the loss of the human soul. Its heroes are the truth-tellers, martyrs, builders, memory-keepers, and ordinary people who preserve the person against abstraction. Its villains are Moloch, the Machine, the Liar, the Hollow King, and the False Prophet. Its wizards are the scientists, poets, philosophers, priests, and technologists who reveal hidden powers, some for healing and some for domination. Its unresolved quest is whether the West can pass through death and become human again.

That is the mythic narrative of the Western Tradition after 1914.



# Part II - Episode Guide

The micro-drama structure uses short, dramatic episodes with a visible cliffhanger. Each episode should end with an emotional or symbolic hook that naturally forces the next one.

## Season Architecture

| Season                              | Years     | Purpose                                                                            |
|-------------------------------------|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Season One: The Wound               | 1914-1919 | The old world dies in the trenches.                                                |
| Season Two: The False Resurrections | 1920-1938 | Ideologies rise to replace God, father, and tradition.                             |
| Season Three: The Dragon War        | 1939-1945 | The West fights monstrous evil and discovers its own terrible power.               |
| Season Four: The Atomic Twilight    | 1945-1968 | Comfort, Cold War, civil rights, sexuality, faith, and rebellion reshape the soul. |
| Season Five: The Mirror Cracks      | 1969-1989 | Cynicism, truth-telling, technology, markets, and the fall of communism.           |
| Season Six: The Victorious Orphan   | 1990-2007 | The West wins the Cold War but loses its plot.                                     |
| Season Seven: The Mirror Kingdom    | 2008-2024 | Screens, platforms, identity, loneliness, AI, and the first hints of return.       |

## Season One: The Wound (1914-1919)

| Ep | Title                                    | Micro-drama synopsis + cliffhanger                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|----|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | <b>The Gunshot at the Edge of Empire</b> | The assassination ignites a chain of treaties, pride, fear, and old grudges. Europe's kings and ministers act like they are moving pieces on a board, but the board is alive. Cliffhanger: The trains begin to move. |
| 2  | <b>The Boys Who Cheered</b>              | Young men march off expecting glory. Mothers wave flags. Priests bless regiments. Poets talk of honor. Then the first shells fall. Cliffhanger: The golden road ends in mud.                                         |
| 3  | <b>The Trench Opens</b>                  | The West descends into the underworld: barbed wire, rats, gas, artillery, and endless waiting. The old heroic code cracks. Cliffhanger: A soldier hears a voice under the battlefield calling his name.              |
| 4  | <b>Moloch Eats the Sons</b>              | The war machine demands more bodies. Generals speak of strategy while boys vanish by the thousands. Moloch's altar is revealed. Cliffhanger: The dead begin to outnumber the living.                                 |
| 5  | <b>The Christmas Truce</b>               | For one night, enemies sing across the mud, exchange gifts, and bury the dead. The human face briefly defeats the machine. Cliffhanger: Commanders order the miracle to stop.                                        |
| 6  | <b>The Poison Cloud</b>                  | Gas drifts over the trenches like a green demon. Science, once promised as salvation, becomes a weapon of terror. Cliffhanger: The West realizes knowledge without wisdom is sorcery.                                |
| 7  | <b>The Soldier-Poet's Last Letter</b>    | A young poet writes that glory was a lie, but love was not. His words survive when his body does not. Cliffhanger: His letter reaches home after his funeral.                                                        |
| 8  | <b>The Red Door Opens</b>                | In Russia, hunger, war, and fury break the old order. A new prophet promises paradise without God. Cliffhanger: The revolutionaries discover that paradise needs prisons.                                            |
| 9  | <b>The Armistice That Was Not Peace</b>  | Bells ring. Crowds cheer. The guns stop. But the wounded West is not healed, only exhausted. Cliffhanger: In the treaty room, humiliation is written into the future.                                                |
| 10 | <b>The Lost Generation</b>               | Survivors return home, but the old songs sound false. The West has won and lost at the same time. Cliffhanger: Into the spiritual emptiness, new saviors arrive.                                                     |

## Season Two: The False Resurrections (1920-1938)

| Ep | Title                                   | Micro-drama synopsis + cliffhanger                                                                                                                                                                  |
|----|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 11 | <b>The Jazz Mask</b>                    | The 1920s glitter with speed, sex, money, and music. The West dances to avoid remembering the dead. Cliffhanger: Beneath the dance floor, the wound starts bleeding again.                          |
| 12 | <b>The Wizard of the Unconscious</b>    | Freud opens the locked basement of the self. Modern man learns he is not master in his own house. Cliffhanger: If reason is not king, what is?                                                      |
| 13 | <b>The Prophet of Class Fire</b>        | Marx's ghost walks through factories and meeting halls. His disciples promise the oppressed a new heaven on earth. Cliffhanger: The new heaven begins compiling lists of enemies.                   |
| 14 | <b>The Man With the Little Mustache</b> | A failed artist becomes a voice for humiliation, resentment, and rebirth. The crowd laughs at first. Then it listens. Cliffhanger: The crowd raises its arm.                                        |
| 15 | <b>The Blackshirt Spell</b>             | Italy's strongman turns politics into theater: uniforms, marches, myths, and violence. The Hollow King learns that spectacle can replace truth. Cliffhanger: Other wounded nations take notes.      |
| 16 | <b>The Market Temple Falls</b>          | The crash of 1929 shatters faith in endless prosperity. The idol of money collapses, and people search for harsher gods. Cliffhanger: Desperation makes the crowd easy to summon.                   |
| 17 | <b>Breadlines and New Deals</b>         | America tries to save itself through dams, programs, work, and management. Some are helped. Others fear the state is becoming a new father. Cliffhanger: The question returns: who owns the future? |
| 18 | <b>The Book Burners</b>                 | The Liar teaches a nation to hate words, memory, and inconvenient truth. Books burn before bodies do. Cliffhanger: A child asks why the fire smells like paper and fear.                            |
| 19 | <b>The Racial Idol</b>                  | Blood, soil, and purity become a dark religion. The person disappears beneath category and mythic rage. Cliffhanger: The trains are rebuilt for another purpose.                                    |
| 20 | <b>The Exiles</b>                       | Jewish families, artists, scientists, priests, and dissidents flee while others insist things will calm down. Cliffhanger: The doors of escape begin to close.                                      |
| 21 | <b>Appeasement at the Banquet</b>       | Leaders try to feed the dragon small nations so it will sleep. It only grows stronger. Cliffhanger: The dragon turns toward Poland.                                                                 |
| 22 | <b>The Last Summer Before Fire</b>      | Ordinary people picnic, marry, study, and shop while storm clouds gather. The West feels the old nightmare returning. Cliffhanger: Dawn breaks over September 1939.                                 |

## Season Three: The Dragon War (1939-1945)

| Ep | Title                                | Micro-drama synopsis + cliffhanger                                                                                                                                                                |
|----|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 23 | <b>The Dragon Crosses the Border</b> | Poland falls beneath mechanized fury. The old rules of war collapse. Cliffhanger: The world realizes this will not be like last time.                                                             |
| 24 | <b>The Lion Refuses the Dark</b>     | Britain stands alone. Churchill, flawed but fierce, becomes the old lion at the gate. Cliffhanger: The sky fills with bombers.                                                                    |
| 25 | <b>The City Under Fire</b>           | London burns, but people sing in shelters and dig through rubble. The human spirit becomes a weapon. Cliffhanger: Across the ocean, another giant listens.                                        |
| 26 | <b>The Secret War of Codes</b>       | Mathematicians, spies, and quiet geniuses fight in shadows. The wizardry of numbers begins saving lives. Cliffhanger: A decoded message reveals something worse than invasion.                    |
| 27 | <b>The Camps Behind the Curtain</b>  | Rumors become reports. Reports become horror. The anti-cathedral of modernity is being built. Cliffhanger: A prisoner smuggles out the truth.                                                     |
| 28 | <b>The Priest in the Bunker</b>      | Bonhoeffer chooses conspiracy over safe piety. Faith becomes resistance. Cliffhanger: The plot fails, and the gallows wait.                                                                       |
| 29 | <b>The Saint of Auschwitz</b>        | Maximilian Kolbe steps forward to die in another man's place. In the center of Moloch's kingdom, sacrifice is redeemed. Cliffhanger: The guards cannot understand what they have seen.            |
| 30 | <b>The Arsenal Awakens</b>           | America enters the war after Pearl Harbor. Factories roar, ships launch, and the machine is turned against the dragon. Cliffhanger: But machine versus machine has a terrible cost.               |
| 31 | <b>The Red Winter</b>                | Stalingrad becomes a frozen mouth swallowing armies. The Nazi myth breaks against hunger, cold, and blood. Cliffhanger: The other dragon, Soviet power, grows larger in victory.                  |
| 32 | <b>The Longest Day</b>               | D-Day arrives. Ordinary men storm the edge of occupied Europe. Some fall before touching land. Cliffhanger: Liberation begins, but the camps are still hidden.                                    |
| 33 | <b>The Gates Open</b>                | The Allies discover the camps. Civilization looks at what modern man did with paperwork, trains, doctors, and ideology. Cliffhanger: No one knows how to live after seeing it.                    |
| 34 | <b>The Fire From Heaven</b>          | Oppenheimer's wizard-fire ends the war in the Pacific and opens the atomic age. The West defeats one apocalypse by inventing another. Cliffhanger: The hero now holds the power to end the world. |

## Season Four: The Atomic Twilight (1945-1968)

| Ep | Title                                    | Micro-drama synopsis + cliffhanger                                                                                                                                                                               |
|----|------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 35 | <b>The Trial of Monsters</b>             | Nuremberg tries to name evil in legal language. The world says "never again," but already new camps remain open elsewhere. Cliffhanger: Justice looks east and sees a locked door.                               |
| 36 | <b>The Iron Curtain Falls</b>            | Europe is divided by ideology. The West saves half the city but loses the other half to the Red Leviathan. Cliffhanger: Families wake up on opposite sides of history.                                           |
| 37 | <b>The Suburban Promise</b>              | Houses, cars, washing machines, and television promise peace. The soldier comes home, but his nightmares follow him into the living room. Cliffhanger: Comfort cannot bury the dead forever.                     |
| 38 | <b>The Baby Boom Baptism</b>             | Children fill the suburbs. The West tries to restart itself through family, church, school, and prosperity. Cliffhanger: The children will inherit a world their parents cannot explain.                         |
| 39 | <b>The Wizard of the Wardrobe</b>        | C.S. Lewis and Tolkien reopen the door to myth. Children meet lions, rings, hobbits, kings, and sacrificial love. Cliffhanger: The old stories are not dead after all.                                           |
| 40 | <b>The Bomb Shelter Catechism</b>        | Children practice hiding under desks. The West teaches its young to fear the sky. Cliffhanger: One wrong button could erase every story.                                                                         |
| 41 | <b>The Spy in the Mirror</b>             | The Cold War turns truth into a maze of secrets, double agents, and paranoia. Everyone wonders who is lying. Cliffhanger: The Liar learns to wear respectable clothes.                                           |
| 42 | <b>The Dream at the Lincoln Memorial</b> | Martin Luther King Jr. calls America back to its own creed. The promise of human dignity becomes prophetic fire. Cliffhanger: Prophets make enemies.                                                             |
| 43 | <b>The Pope and the Council</b>          | The Church tries to speak to modern man without losing its soul. Windows open, but so do storms. Cliffhanger: Renewal and confusion arrive together.                                                             |
| 44 | <b>The Pill and the Promise</b>          | Sexual liberation is sold as freedom from consequence. The body becomes a battlefield. Cliffhanger: A revolution begins inside the home.                                                                         |
| 45 | <b>The Assassinated Decade</b>           | JFK, Malcolm X, MLK, and RFK fall. Hope itself seems hunted. Cliffhanger: The children of the suburbs take to the streets.                                                                                       |
| 46 | <b>1968: The Children Revolt</b>         | Students, radicals, artists, and dreamers attack the institutions that raised them. Some seek justice. Some seek destruction. Cliffhanger: Once the father is overthrown, who teaches the children what to love? |

## Season Five: The Mirror Cracks (1969-1989)

| Ep | Title                               | Micro-drama synopsis + cliffhanger                                                                                                                                                                    |
|----|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 47 | <b>The Moon and the Abyss</b>       | Man walks on the moon, the last great heroic ascent of technological modernity. But back on Earth, the soul remains restless. Cliffhanger: We reached the heavens and still could not find home.      |
| 48 | <b>The War on the Screen</b>        | Vietnam brings war into the living room. Trust in leaders, generals, and institutions fractures. Cliffhanger: The screen becomes more powerful than the throne.                                       |
| 49 | <b>The Whistleblower's Door</b>     | Watergate reveals corruption behind polished power. The Hollow King is exposed, but cynicism becomes its own poison. Cliffhanger: If all leaders lie, who can be believed?                            |
| 50 | <b>The Gulag Manuscript</b>         | Solzhenitsyn returns from the underworld carrying testimony. The West reads what ideology did in the name of liberation. Cliffhanger: The Red Leviathan has a weakness: truth.                        |
| 51 | <b>The Market Wizard Returns</b>    | Inflation, stagnation, oil shocks, and malaise haunt the West. A new promise rises: markets, deregulation, competition, growth. Cliffhanger: The Market can create wealth, but can it create meaning? |
| 52 | <b>The Polish Pope</b>              | John Paul II steps onto the world stage like a priest-king from an older story. He tells the fearful: "Be not afraid." Cliffhanger: Behind the Iron Curtain, workers begin to whisper.                |
| 53 | <b>Solidarity</b>                   | Shipyard workers kneel, strike, pray, and organize. The weak discover they are not alone. Cliffhanger: The empire sends tanks of silence.                                                             |
| 54 | <b>The Cathedral of Consumption</b> | The shopping mall becomes a temple of peace, identity, and desire. The False Prophet says happiness can be purchased. Cliffhanger: The children learn to confuse choice with freedom.                 |
| 55 | <b>The Personal Computer Spell</b>  | A new kind of wizardry enters the home. The machine becomes personal, promising creativity and control. Cliffhanger: The mirror is still small, but it is learning.                                   |
| 56 | <b>The Evil Empire Speech</b>       | The West names Soviet power as moral evil, not just geopolitical rival. The language of good and evil returns to politics. Cliffhanger: Naming the dragon awakens it.                                 |
| 57 | <b>Chernobyl: The Reactor Lies</b>  | A nuclear disaster reveals the cost of official falsehood. Radiation spreads, but the greater poison is the lie. Cliffhanger: The empire cannot contain invisible truth.                              |
| 58 | <b>The Wall Cracks</b>              | Protesters gather, prayers rise, borders tremble. The old concrete scar begins to fail. Cliffhanger: A confused official opens the gate.                                                              |
| 59 | <b>The Night the Wall Fell</b>      | Berlin erupts in tears, hammers, embraces, and disbelief. The West thinks history has ended. Cliffhanger: But victory over the dragon is not the same as healing the soul.                            |

## Season Six: The Victorious Orphan (1990-2007)

| Ep | Title                             | Micro-drama synopsis + cliffhanger                                                                                                                                                                  |
|----|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 60 | <b>The End of History Party</b>   | The West celebrates itself: democracy, markets, globalization, peace. It thinks the final boss is defeated. Cliffhanger: Pride returns wearing a business suit.                                     |
| 61 | <b>The Forgotten Graves</b>       | In the Balkans, old hatreds return. Europe learns that modern borders do not erase ancient wounds. Cliffhanger: The dragon of tribe was only sleeping.                                              |
| 62 | <b>The Internet Opens</b>         | The web arrives as a democratic dream: knowledge, connection, creativity. A new realm is born. Cliffhanger: Every realm eventually attracts demons.                                                 |
| 63 | <b>The Clone of Desire</b>        | Advertising, cable, celebrity, and consumer identity merge. The person becomes a target market. Cliffhanger: The Machine discovers how to monetize longing.                                         |
| 64 | <b>The Child With the Console</b> | Video games, fantasy franchises, and digital worlds become new mythic playgrounds. The old heroic quest returns through screens. Cliffhanger: But what happens when play becomes escape?            |
| 65 | <b>The Towers Fall</b>            | September 11 shatters the illusion of permanent safety. Fire, ash, sacrifice, and terror return in a single morning. Cliffhanger: The West prepares to fight an enemy it does not fully understand. |
| 66 | <b>The War Without an Ending</b>  | The War on Terror begins with moral clarity and drifts into ambiguity, surveillance, fatigue, and unintended consequences. Cliffhanger: To defeat the enemy, the West builds a watching machine.    |
| 67 | <b>The Patriot Mirror</b>         | Security expands. Airports, data, borders, and fear are reorganized. Citizens accept new powers for protection. Cliffhanger: The Machine learns that fear makes people obedient.                    |
| 68 | <b>The Smartphone Seed</b>        | The first smartphones gather scattered powers into one object: map, camera, marketplace, diary, mirror, oracle. Cliffhanger: Soon, everyone will carry the Mirror Kingdom in their pocket.          |

## Season Seven: The Mirror Kingdom (2008-2024)

| Ep | Title                                     | Micro-drama synopsis + cliffhanger                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|----|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 69 | <b>The Crash of the Golden Algorithm</b>  | The financial crisis reveals that the wizards of money did not understand their own spells. Trust collapses again. Cliffhanger: Rage searches for a target.                                                                          |
| 70 | <b>The Feed Is Born</b>                   | Social platforms promise connection and give everyone a stage. The crowd becomes permanent. Cliffhanger: The Liar learns to go viral.                                                                                                |
| 71 | <b>The Self Becomes a Brand</b>           | Ordinary people become performers of identity. The old soul is replaced by profile, image, metrics, and audience. Cliffhanger: A girl deletes a post and feels like she deleted herself.                                             |
| 72 | <b>The New Tribal Fire</b>                | Politics becomes identity war. Every disagreement becomes sacred conflict. The village square burns inside the phone. Cliffhanger: The West remembers how to hate before it remembers how to pray.                                   |
| 73 | <b>The Lonely Crowd</b>                   | Everyone is connected, but depression, isolation, addiction, and distrust spread. The Mirror gives attention but not communion. Cliffhanger: A child asks why everyone is looking down.                                              |
| 74 | <b>The Pandemic Door</b>                  | The world locks itself indoors. Bodies become threats, faces disappear, rituals break, screens replace touch. Cliffhanger: When the doors reopen, people are not the same.                                                           |
| 75 | <b>The Empty Church and the Loud Feed</b> | Institutions lose authority: churches, media, universities, parties, experts. The vacuum fills with influencers, gurus, conspiracies, and algorithmic prophets. Cliffhanger: When no one trusts the priest, they trust the magician. |
| 76 | <b>The Algorithmic Oracle</b>             | AI begins answering, creating, imitating, predicting. The West meets a talking mirror that sounds almost human. Cliffhanger: The Orphan asks the machine: "Do I have a soul?"                                                        |
| 77 | <b>The Return of the Body</b>             | A countercurrent begins: localism, family, fitness, liturgy, craft, farming, homeschooling, old books, real food, face-to-face community. Cliffhanger: The Machine notices people leaving the mirror.                                |
| 78 | <b>The Rage of the Hollow King</b>        | The old managerial elite cannot inspire love, only compliance. The populist revolt cannot yet build, only expose. Cliffhanger: Both sides claim to save the West, but neither can resurrect it.                                      |
| 79 | <b>The Child at the Ruins</b>             | A new generation wanders through ruins of faith, family, nation, and meaning. Some despair. Some begin asking forbidden questions. Cliffhanger: The oldest door starts glowing again.                                                |
| 80 | <b>The Keeper of Memory</b>               | The Memory-Keeper gathers fragments: Homer, Scripture, Dante, Shakespeare, Tolkien, the martyrs, the soldiers, the mothers, the forgotten dead. Cliffhanger: The Orphan finally asks: "What if home still exists?"                   |
| 81 | <b>The Table in the Dark</b>              | A family, a parish, a neighborhood, and a group of friends choose embodied life over abstraction. Smallness becomes rebellion. Cliffhanger: Moloch laughs: "You think dinner can defeat me?"                                         |
| 82 | <b>The Last Temptation of the West</b>    | The False Prophet offers one final bargain: perfect comfort, endless entertainment, no suffering, no memory, no repentance. Cliffhanger: The West reaches for the cup.                                                               |
| 83 | <b>The Refusal</b>                        | The Orphan rejects comfort without meaning. It chooses burden, limits, worship, family, truth, beauty, and the face of the other. Cliffhanger: The Machine declares this choice irrational.                                          |
| 84 | <b>The Human Face</b>                     | The West looks at the person again: unborn, old, poor, disabled, enemy, stranger, child, neighbor, prisoner. Not category. Not data. Not machine. Person. Cliffhanger: The old villains gather for one last assault.                 |
| 85 | <b>The Trial of the Machine</b>           | The Machine is forced to answer: What is man for? It can optimize, simulate, predict, and scale, but it cannot love. Cliffhanger: The Machine whispers, "But they love me."                                                          |
| 86 | <b>The Myth Returns</b>                   | The West realizes myth was never childish. Bad myths enslaved it. True myth may restore it. Cliffhanger: The Orphan discovers the story was never only about the West.                                                               |
| 87 | <b>The Unfinished Resurrection</b>        | The West is not saved yet. It is kneeling between death and rebirth. The choice is no longer empire or decline, but incarnation or disembodiment. Cliffhanger: A child opens an old book and says, "Begin again?"                    |

| Ep | Title                     | Micro-drama synopsis + cliffhanger                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|----|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 88 | <b>The Door of Return</b> | The final episode ends not with triumph, but with a threshold: home, altar, table, school, workshop, garden, story, song. The West steps forward. Cliffhanger: On the other side of the door, something ancient is waiting. |



# Part III - Production Approach and Tool Stack

## Creative Decision

**Make it a stylized animated myth-drama, not live action first.**

The visual target is a mythic graphic novel meets stained-glass propaganda poster meets animated historical epic. This is not cartoon comedy, not Pixar, not anime-first, and not photoreal fake history. The goal is emotional authority, continuity, and speed.

## Show Format Rules

- 9:16 vertical format.
- 60-90 second episodes.
- 6-9 clips per episode.
- Each generated clip should stay between 6 and 10 seconds.
- Voiceover-driven, with limited dialogue.
- Recurring archetypal characters over photoreal historical impersonations.
- Strong repeated symbols: trenches, towers, mirrors, fire, masks, machines, books, doors.

## Recurring Mythic Cast for Production

| Character                  | Function                                                                                      | Continuity Anchor                                                                   |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The Orphaned West          | Main character. Brilliant, wounded, proud, guilty, creative, and searching for home.          | Key necklace, tired blue-gray eyes, old book/candle, era-specific costume.          |
| The Soldier-Sufferer       | The human witness to the cost of pride, war, ideology, and abstraction.                       | Mud, letter, prayer card, haunted eyes.                                             |
| The Keeper of Memory       | Preserves the old stories and reminds the West who it is.                                     | Library, candle, cloak, fragments of Homer, Scripture, Dante, Shakespeare, Tolkien. |
| Moloch                     | The god of sacrifice that demands bodies for progress, purity, class, safety, or convenience. | Furnace, altar, shadow mouth, never fully shown.                                    |
| The Machine Without a Soul | Technology, bureaucracy, and optimization detached from wisdom.                               | Steel face, many hands, ledgers, wires, cold light.                                 |
| The Liar                   | Propaganda, euphemism, manipulation, and official falsehood.                                  | Changing mask, beautiful voice, proximity to power.                                 |
| The Hollow King            | Decadent leadership with power but no sacred vision.                                          | Paper crown, polished suit, empty eyes.                                             |
| The False Prophet          | The fake savior of each era.                                                                  | Costume changes by era: revolutionary, advertiser, influencer, technocrat.          |
| The Child                  | The future asking, "What is this all for?"                                                    | Open book, glowing door, direct gaze.                                               |

## Least-Tool Production Stack

The objective is to minimize touch points. The web-app version can work for testing, but the serious version should run through APIs and a repo.

| Function                         | Recommended Tool                               | Why                                                                                                                                      |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Command center                   | Codex or Claude Code                           | One interface for files, scripts, repo operations, prompts, and approval gates.                                                          |
| Writing + prompts + style frames | OpenAI API                                     | Text generation plus image generation/editing through GPT Image models.                                                                  |
| Video clips                      | Runway API first; Google Veo/Gemini API second | Runway supports image/text-to-video workflows and Gen-4.5 durations from 2-10 seconds; Veo 3.1 is strong but centers on 8-second videos. |
| Narration + voices               | ElevenLabs API                                 | Consistent narrator and character voices through REST API and SDKs.                                                                      |
| Assembly                         | FFmpeg                                         | Automated concatenation, transcoding, captions, and vertical exports.                                                                    |
| Storage                          | Local repo + Google Drive backup               | Versioned production files with simple cloud backup.                                                                                     |
| Review UI                        | Generated HTML review page                     | Laurent reviews only decisions: script, references, clip takes, final edit.                                                              |

## Current Tool Notes Verified for This PDF

- OpenAI image generation is suitable for programmatic style frames, character sheets, and reference imagery using GPT Image models.
- OpenAI Sora 2 video models and the Videos API are deprecated in current OpenAI API documentation with removal scheduled for September 24, 2026, so this plan does not rely on Sora as the video layer.
- Runway API exposes video generation endpoints and its changelog states Gen-4.5 supports text-to-video and image-to-video with durations from 2 to 10 seconds, making it a strong fit for this project.
- Google Veo 3.1 through the Gemini API is a strong alternate path, but the official guide describes 8-second videos, so it is slightly less aligned to a strict 10-second clip standard.
- ElevenLabs provides text-to-speech and generative audio capabilities through REST API and official SDKs, making it practical for consistent narration.
- FFmpeg concat demuxer is appropriate for automatically stitching approved generated clips when codecs and dimensions are normalized.

## Shot Card Grammar

The atomic unit of the show is not a screenplay page. It is a 6-10 second shot card. One shot card equals one video generation task.

| Time      | Shot            | Purpose                  |
|-----------|-----------------|--------------------------|
| 0-3 sec   | Cold open image | Stop the scroll.         |
| 3-10 sec  | Shot 1          | Set the mythic problem.  |
| 10-20 sec | Shot 2          | Show the human cost.     |
| 20-30 sec | Shot 3          | Introduce force/villain. |
| 30-40 sec | Shot 4          | Reversal.                |
| 40-50 sec | Shot 5          | Emotional punch.         |
| 50-60 sec | Shot 6          | Cliffhanger.             |

# Part IV - Automation Consolidation Plan

The production system should feel like one machine. Codex or Claude Code becomes the single front door; the scripts and APIs do the work underneath. The only human bottleneck should be taste, approvals, and final judgment.

## The Four Human Checkpoints

- Checkpoint 1: approve the series bible, visual style, core cast, and tone.
- Checkpoint 2: approve episode scripts, shot cards, voiceover, and prompts.
- Checkpoint 3: select approved clip takes from two or three generated options per shot.
- Checkpoint 4: approve final vertical export.

## Recommended Repository Structure

```
orphaned-west/  
bible/  
series_bible.md  
visual_style_bible.md  
character_bible.md  
prompt_bible.md  
seasons/  
season_01/  
episodes/  
ep001/  
script.md  
shot_cards.json  
prompts.json  
review_notes.md  
outputs/  
clips/  
audio/  
final/  
assets/  
characters/  
orphaned_west/  
soldier_sufferer/  
keeper_of_memory/  
moloch/  
machine_without_soul/  
liar/  
locations/  
golden_city/  
trench/  
moloch_furnace/  
mirror_kingdom/  
style_refs/  
pipeline/  
generate_script.py  
generate_prompts.py  
generate_images.py  
generate_video.py  
generate_voice.py  
stitch_episode.py  
qa_episode.py  
reviews/  
needs_laurent/  
approved/  
rejected/  
config/  
show_config.yaml  
api_keys.example
```

## Core CLI Commands

```
ow script S01E01
ow prompts S01E01
ow images S01E01
ow video S01E01 --takes 3
ow voice S01E01
ow edit S01E01
ow review S01E01
```

Plain English commands inside Codex or Claude Code should map to these scripts. For example: "Create the full production package for S01E01, but stop before video generation and put it in the review folder."

## Core Data File: shot\_cards.json

```
{
  "episode_id": "S01E01",
  "title": "The Gunshot at the Edge of Empire",
  "duration_seconds": 60,
  "aspect_ratio": "9:16",
  "style_ref": "TOW_STYLE_MASTER_V01",
  "voice_id": "NARRATOR_GRAVE_V01",
  "clips": [
    {
      "clip_id": "S01E01_C01",
      "duration": 10,
      "visual": "Golden European city under gaslight, trains, churches, factories.",
      "voiceover": "Before the wound, the West believed it had outgrown the gods.",
      "characters": [
        "ORPHANED_WEST"
      ],
      "location": "GOLDEN_CITY",
      "camera": "slow push toward clock tower",
      "mood": "majestic dread",
      "status": "needs_generation"
    }
  ]
}
```

## show\_config.yaml

```
series_title: "The Orphaned West"
format: "vertical mythic animated drama"
aspect_ratio: "9:16"
episode_length_seconds: 75
clip_length_seconds: 10
takes_per_clip: 3

style:
  master: "mythic animated graphic novel, stained-glass lighting, historical symbolism, solemn, cinematic"
  avoid:
    - photoreal celebrity likeness
    - comedy
    - anime exaggeration
    - gore
    - modern logos
    - random text
    - distorted hands
    - changing character faces

approval_gates:
  require_script_approval: true
  require_reference_image_approval: true
  require_clip_selection: true
  require_final_export_approval: true
```

## Automation Pipeline

| Step                   | Machine output                                                        | Laurent reviews                      |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| 1. Package episode     | script.md, shot_cards.json, prompts.json, voiceover.txt, captions.srt | Script and shot cards only.          |
| 2. Generate references | character sheets, location stills, first-frame images                 | Approve/reject visual continuity.    |
| 3. Generate videos     | two or three takes per clip                                           | Choose best take or request regen.   |
| 4. Generate narration  | consistent narrator/character audio                                   | Approve tone, pacing, pronunciation. |
| 5. Assemble final      | vertical MP4 with captions, voice, music bed, end hook                | Final approval.                      |

## Review Page Requirements

The system should generate a local HTML review page for each episode. The page should show script, shot cards, generated references, all clip takes, radio buttons for approve/regenerate, and a notes field. That prevents the showrunner from opening folders manually.

## First Three Milestones

- Milestone 1: trailer factory - create a 90-second proof trailer with the full visual language.
- Milestone 2: episode factory - automate S01E01 from script to final export.
- Milestone 3: batch mode - produce S01E02 to S01E05 through the same approved pipeline.

## Critical Production Rule

### **Three rolls per clip, then move on.**

Generate version A, B, and C; choose the strongest; edit around minor flaws. The goal is a consistent, emotionally clear episode, not infinite perfection.

# Appendix A - Episode 1 Shot Cards

Episode 1 is the prototype unit because it establishes the grammar: one symbolic action, one voiceover line, one cliff motion.

| Clip | Visual                                                            | Voiceover                                                       | Cliff motion                                     |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Golden European city under gaslight, trains, churches, factories. | Before the wound, the West believed it had outgrown the gods.   | Camera pushes toward clock tower.                |
| 2    | Young nobleman's car moving through a crowded street.             | It trusted treaties, machines, markets, and manners.            | A shadow crosses the street.                     |
| 3    | A hand reaches inside a coat.                                     | But under the marble floor, something ancient was awake.        | Fingers touch a pistol.                          |
| 4    | The gunshot, shown symbolically as birds exploding into the sky.  | One shot cracked the mask of civilization.                      | Bells begin ringing.                             |
| 5    | Maps ignite, train lines glow red across Europe.                  | Kings and ministers thought they were moving pieces on a board. | The map starts bleeding.                         |
| 6    | Young soldier looking from train window directly at viewer.       | But the board was alive.                                        | Text/card: By Christmas, they said we'd be home. |

# Appendix B - Video Prompt Template

Series: The Orphaned West  
Episode: [Episode number and title]  
Clip: [Clip number]  
Aspect ratio: 9:16 vertical  
Duration: 8-10 seconds  
Style lock: mythic animated graphic novel, painted cinematic lighting, stained-glass color accents, historical symbolism, solemn tone, not photoreal, not anime, not comedy  
Characters: [insert exact character bible description]  
Location: [insert location bible description]  
Action: [one simple action only]  
Camera: [slow push-in / pan / tracking / locked-off]  
Mood: [dread / wonder / grief / revelation]  
Avoid: extra characters, changed clothing, modern objects, text, logos, distorted hands, warped faces, gore  
Continuity note: use the same face, costume, color palette, and symbolic object as reference image [asset name]

# Appendix C - Production Bible Files to Create First

- series\_bible.md - premise, tone, moral frame, audience, episode format, recurring symbols, and prohibitions.
- character\_bible.md - locked character descriptions, visual references, era variants, and continuity anchors.
- visual\_style\_bible.md - color palette, lighting, composition, historical texture, and prohibited styles.
- prompt\_bible.md - reusable prompt templates for images, video, voice, captions, and QA.
- pipeline\_spec.md - commands, folders, file naming, API providers, review gates, and failure handling.

# Appendix D - References and Source Notes

The creative material in Parts I and II is compiled from the three uploaded source drafts in this conversation. Current production-tool notes were checked against official product/API documentation on May 21, 2026.

- OpenAI image generation API: <https://developers.openai.com/api/docs/guides/image-generation>
- OpenAI GPT Image 2 model details: <https://developers.openai.com/api/docs/models/gpt-image-2>
- OpenAI API deprecations: Sora 2 video models and Videos API: <https://developers.openai.com/api/docs/deprecations>
- Runway API reference: <https://docs.dev.runwayml.com/api/>
- Runway API changelog: Gen-4.5 durations 2-10 seconds: [https://docs.dev.runwayml.com/api-details/api\\_changelog/](https://docs.dev.runwayml.com/api-details/api_changelog/)
- Runway API SDKs: <https://docs.dev.runwayml.com/api-details/sdks/>
- Google Gemini API Veo 3.1 video generation: <https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/video>
- ElevenLabs API overview: <https://elevenlabs.io/docs/overview/intro>
- ElevenLabs text-to-speech API: <https://elevenlabs.io/docs/api-reference/text-to-speech/convert>
- Claude Code overview: <https://docs.anthropic.com/en/docs/agents-and-tools/claude-code/overview>
- Claude Code Agent SDK overview: <https://docs.anthropic.com/en/docs/claude-code/sdk>
- Claude Code hooks guide: <https://docs.anthropic.com/en/docs/claude-code/hooks-guide>
- OpenAI Codex product page: <https://openai.com/codex/>
- OpenAI Codex IDE extension docs: <https://developers.openai.com/codex/ide>
- FFmpeg concat demuxer documentation: <https://ffmpeg.org/ffmpeg-formats.html#concat>

Internal source drafts used: Pasted text(1).txt, Pasted markdown (2).md, and Pasted markdown (3).md.